

than pay bills and die.” That’s easy to forget when you’re stuck on the standard path. We tell our kids they can do and be anything they want, but how many adults actually live that out?

We live in a world that tells us life is hard. Politicians on the left and right tell us our lives will be better if we vote for them. Some think technology will save us. Our consumer culture sells the idea that happiness is a new car, a kitchen remodel, or a fancy vacation away. And there’s always a way to pay. Just apply for a home equity loan or another credit card.

I hate to be the bearer of bad news, but no politician, technology, or consumer good is coming to fix what ails you. The superpower of FI starts with the choice to seek a better life and a belief that one is possible. But that choice and belief become real only when it is followed by action.

If there is a secret to choosing FI, that’s it. This book gives you the action steps to free yourself from the standard path. But freedom is only possible if *you* take the steps to empower yourself.

You can *Choose FI* and get off the hamster wheel. But what do you do with this freedom? What’s the ultimate goal? Many start with the idea of achieving FIRE, but you can decouple FI and RE. FI makes work optional, without worrying about how you’ll make your